Office FitOut planning pack

Project brief & quote comparison checklist

01 / READY TO BRIEF

12 checks before you commit.

Tick only when the evidence is recorded. Mark unknowns for follow-up. Use the next pages to turn these checks into a brief, comparable proposals and clear decisions.

- [ ] **01 Define the workplace outcome**

  Record team activities, peak attendance, storage, visitors and what must work on opening day.

- [ ] **02 Record the premises**

  Gather available plans and photos; have relevant specialists verify dimensions and service constraints.

- [ ] **03 Name the project team**

  Identify client decision maker, landlord contact, designer, advisers and appointed contractors.

- [ ] **04 Issue one written scope**

  Date the brief, drawings and specification revision used for each proposal.

- [ ] **05 Separate budget allowances**

  Distinguish confirmed quotations, provisional allowances, exclusions and unpriced items.

- [ ] **06 Compare the whole budget**

  Include professional inputs, works, services, furniture, IT, transition and contingency.

- [ ] **07 Confirm approval dependencies**

  Ask appointed advisers what applies to the actual premises, proposed use and works.

- [ ] **08 Plan business continuity**

  Record staging, staff access, disruption limits and IT changeovers with the project team.

- [ ] **09 Coordinate furniture and works**

  Check layout, dimensions, power and data before fixing service positions or ordering.

- [ ] **10 Verify availability**

  Obtain project-specific contractor and supplier dates; record what remains unconfirmed.

- [ ] **11 Define handover evidence**

  Agree required approvals, testing, instructions, warranties and the defects process.

- [ ] **12 Agree the next decision**

  Assign an owner, evidence needed and a decision date to each unresolved issue.

Office FitOut planning pack

Project brief & quote comparison checklist

02 / PREMISES & WORKPLACE BRIEF

Make the unknowns visible.

Complete with your team before requesting proposals. For Newcastle CBD or upper-floor sites, confirm building-specific loading, lift and access arrangements; do not assume they are standard.

Project / site address / floor / council area

Client decision maker / landlord or building manager contact

Current condition / available plans / investigations still required

Peak attendance / work activities / visitors / storage / accessible use

Essential for opening / useful if affordable / later stage

Retained furniture / IT or services dependencies / access restrictions

Target occupation date / dependencies / agreed next step

Office FitOut planning pack

Project brief & quote comparison checklist

03 / LIKE-FOR-LIKE PROPOSALS

Compare scope before totals.

Use one brief revision. Enter I = included, E = excluded, A = allowance or U = unconfirmed, with a note or amount. A blank or unpriced item is not zero. Request written clarification before choosing.

Brief / drawing revision and date

Scope or assumption	Proposal A	Proposal B	Proposal C
Professional inputs / approvals			
Existing works / landlord scope			
Building works / finishes			
Mechanical / electrical / fire			
IT / data / security			
Furniture / named specifications			
Delivery / assembly / waste			
Access / staging / disruption			
Allowances / exclusions			
GST / total / validity			
Programme / dependencies			
Warranty / testing / handover			

Key scope gaps / written clarification requested / revised offer date

Office FitOut planning pack

Project brief & quote comparison checklist

04 / DECISIONS & OCCUPATION

Close the loop before moving in.

An illustrative planning record, not a construction programme, approval assessment or permission to occupy. Appointed specialists determine evidence for their scope; your solicitor advises on lease obligations.

Decision / evidence needed	Owner	Needed by	Confirmed / next action
Premises / landlord conditions			
Approval pathway / occupation			
Scope / budget approval			
Contractor / supplier appointments			
Access / IT / furniture sequence			
Testing / documents / warranties			
Open defects / response dates			

Next decision and the evidence needed to make it

YOS acts as client-side project manager, not the builder or head contractor. Appropriately appointed and licensed contractors perform construction and trade work.

Read the local guide: yourofficespace.au/blog/office-fitout-newcastle-planning-checklist

Official starting points: City of Newcastle, Building and Construction; NSW Planning Portal, Change of Use. Reviewed 27 October 2026. Confirm the authority and requirements for your actual address.